RED & YELLOW

# The Creativity Suite

## A NEUROMARKETING PROPOSAL FOR BUSINESS-TRAVELLER HOTEL ROOMS

**Prepared by :**
Hrithika Patalay

# Executive Summary

Red & Yellow Neuromarketing Agency was commissioned by a hotel group to design one of three science-informed room types Relaxation, Creativity, or Wellness for a 50m² ensuite space aimed for business travellers. Most competing teams gravitated toward wellness and relaxation, but our team chose Creativity, reasoning that a traveller on a work trip is arriving to work, not merely to recover, and that a standard room is optimised for rest rather than the cognitive task the guest actually came to do. This lines up with the course's "neuro-consumer" framing: guests rarely choose a room through deliberate comparison of amenities; the choice is shaped by unconscious, emotionally driven responses to the environment itself, which is why the room, not only the marketing copy around it, had to do the persuasive work.

The resulting product, "The Creativity Suite," reorganises the 50m² footprint into four zones: a Sleep Zone, an Ensuite Bathroom and Closet, an Incubation Lounge, and a dedicated Creativity Workspace. Rather than an entirely new room type at high capital cost, we designed a targeted, budget-conscious redesign of the existing footprint to maximise return on investment. The workspace also reflects the "economy of cognitive effort" heuristic. Wireless charging, a single idea wall, and movable seating remove the small frictions that would otherwise pull attention away from the guest's actual work.



Five evidence-based levers underpin the room, each pairing a bottom-up sensory trigger with a top-down interpretive frame: ceiling height priming abstract processing (Meyers-Levy & Zhu, 2007), a blue-dominant palette for approach motivation and creative cognition (Mehta & Zhu, 2009), live plants and natural materials applying Kaplan's (1995) Attention Restoration Theory, and awe evoked through scale and greenery (Chirico et al., 2018). The in-room fragrance draws on smell's direct link to the amygdala-hippocampal complex a strong route into emotional memory which is exactly why, warning against "neuro-bunk," we treat it as a hypothesis to validate rather than an assumed feature. Finally, framing the room as "creativity," not just decor, is grounded in Plassmann et al. (2008) and McClure et al. (2004), who show that framing and brand context modulate reward-related regions such as the hippocampus and orbitofrontal cortex.

The marketing approach uses the four classical appeals from the course. Ethos presents the room as "science-informed," every feature traceable to a peer-reviewed source. Pathos frames it as "your personal studio away from the office," leaning on somatic markers the bodily, felt sense of calm or focus a space evokes rather than generic luxury cues. Kairos surfaces the Creativity Suite as the recommended option at booking, disclosed and opt-in, following distinction between nudging (altering choice architecture while preserving options) and manipulation (concealing intent or removing choice).

# Personal Role and Contribution

My role was creative design and designing the presentation slides. For me, the idea came from something completely outside the assignment: a musician's home recording studio, where the whole point was that the space was physically separate from where he lived, and that separation seemed to be why the work actually got done at his studio. I couldn't stop turning it over the same logic should apply to a hotel room, where most rooms just have a desk pushed into a corner, which is not the same as a room built around the idea of working in it.
So, I made the case to the team that this distinction a room built for work, versus a room that just happens to contain a place to work was the clearest way into the brief. Most other teams went in the wellness and rest direction, which I think is the more obvious read of "hotel room for a tired traveller." But a business traveller is not checking in to switch off, they are checking in to be productive the next morning, and that gap is what we were designing for.

Once the concept was agreed, I worked it into the four-zone layout with the product manager, applying the sensory-marketing framework almost lever by lever: sight, through the blue palette and idea wall; smell, through the pilot fragrance, chosen for its route into emotional memory rather than because it smells pleasant; and touch, through the cooler ambient temperature, tied to a guest feeling the space genuinely belongs to them. I also spent a lot of time keeping the pitch inside the four-slide, under- 6-minutes limit with five levers and four appeals to justify, it would have been easy to let the neuroscience take over, and managing an audience's attention, I realised partway through, is really the same problem as managing a guest's attention inside the room itself.

# Recommendations for Further Research

Our proposal already embeds a validation study before rollout: a randomised A/B comparison of 40–60 business travellers exposed to a standard room or the Creativity Suite, using a short VR walkthrough rather than static images, since VR's "presence" effect can trigger real physiological responses closer to how a guest would actually respond on arrival. We chose eye-tracking, GSR, and ECG over higher-resolution neuroimaging: fMRI and PET offer far greater spatial precision, but are impractical for a hospitality pilot, whereas our chosen biometrics are portable and sufficient to capture arousal and attention. The fragrance is isolated as its own variable, since scent-creativity literature is mixed; caution against overselling unreplicated findings, only a validated fragrance makes the final specification.

Beyond this, we judged a second, later-stage field study more valuable than a new line of enquiry: tracking booking rates, satisfaction, and return-visit rates against the standard room over several months, to confirm whether pre-launch effects translate into real guest behaviour, and to flag any feature to adjust or drop. We were confident in the initial design and its alternatives, so we prioritised this practical, low-cost validation loop over speculative new biometric methods.

# Critical Reflection on Project Development

Looking back at how the project came together, we started with a fairly open brainstorming session, just listing everything a business traveller might want, and only after that narrowed it against the commission's constraints. What strikes me now is that direction was never really the hard part the team landed on Creativity Suite fairly quickly, almost instinctively, and stayed there. The real challenge was quieter: how much neuroscience to put on the slide versus hold back. Once you start explaining the research behind every choice, you can talk for twenty minutes without noticing exactly the trap we were trying to avoid, given that attention itself acts as a filter with limited bandwidth. We handled it by holding hard to the four-slide, within -4.5-minute structure and pushing the rest into how it landed on audience for anticipated questions.

If I am honest about where the proposal is weakest, it is that it is deliberately conservative we redesigned an existing footprint using established findings, prioritising low cost and high return over anything more experimental. I also notice, looking back, that we never touched sound as a design lever, even though the course covered how ambient audio shapes mood and choice; it fell outside the room-layout brief, but a curated soundscape for the workspace feels like an obvious next addition. And the marketing plan stops at booking, it does not follow the guest into the digital journey, where hyper-personalised recommendations could reinforce the same ethos and kairos appeals at the moment someone is choosing online. If I were doing this again, I would want a small qualitative pilot with real business travellers earlier, with disclosed consent for any biometric testing, so guest feedback actually shapes the design rather than only confirms it afterward.

# References


- Chirico, A., Cipresso, P., Yaden, D. B., Biassoni, F., Riva, G., & Gaggioli, A. (2018). Awe enhances creative thinking: An experimental study. Creativity Research Journal, 30(2), 123–131. https://doi.org/10.1080/10400419.2018.1446491
- Damasio, A. R. (1994). Descartes' error: Emotion, reason, and the human brain. Putnam.
- Kaplan, S. (1995). The restorative benefits of nature: Toward an integrative framework. Journal of Environmental Psychology, 15(3), 169–182. https://doi.org/10.1016/0272-4944(95)90001-2
- McClure, S. M., Li, J., Tomlin, D., Cypert, K. S., Montague, L. M., & Montague, P. R. (2004). Neural correlates of behavioral preference for culturally familiar drinks. Neuron, 44(2), 379–387. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuron.2004.09.019
- Mehta, R., & Zhu, R. (2009). Blue or red? Exploring the effect of color on cognitive task performances. Science, 323(5918), 1226–1229. https://doi.org/10.1126/science.1169144
- Meyers-Levy, J., & Zhu, R. (2007). The influence of ceiling height: The effect of priming on the type of processing that people use. Journal of Consumer Research, 34(2), 174–186. https://doi.org/10.1086/519146
- Plassmann, H., O'Doherty, J., Shiv, B., & Rangel, A. (2008). Marketing actions can modulate neural representations of experienced pleasantness. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 105(3), 1050–1055. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.0706929105